

## Competitor Analysis Report: Hoda Bass (hodabass.lk)

Hoda Bass is the most established digital directory for technical and manual labor in Sri Lanka. It serves as a bridge between households and independent service providers.

### 1. Core Business Model: The Passive Directory

Hoda Bass operates as a "Yellow Pages" for the digital age. It is a search-and-find platform where the primary goal is to provide a list of contacts to the user.

- **Discovery Style:** Users search by category (e.g., Painter, Welder) and location (District/City).
- **Communication:** All worker phone numbers are public and visible to any visitor. The platform does not manage the conversation or the booking.
- **Transaction Role:** The website is not involved in the transaction. Once the user finds a number, the interaction moves entirely offline.

### 2. Revenue Model (Income Streams)

The platform does not take a commission from the jobs. Instead, it monetizes through visibility and advertising:

- **Worker Listing Fees:** Service providers pay a fee to have their profiles listed and maintained on the site.
- **Featured Listings (Premium):** Workers can pay extra to stay at the top of the search results for specific categories or regions to get more calls.
- **Display Advertising:** The website hosts third-party banner advertisements (Google Ads) to generate revenue from site traffic.
- **Corporate Partnerships:** They occasionally partner with hardware or tool brands for sponsored placements.

### 3. Operational Features

- **Manual Verification:** They employ a team to call and verify the identity and availability of workers before they are listed.
- **Rating System:** Users can leave star ratings and text comments on worker profiles. However, since the transaction happens offline, there is no technical proof that the reviewer actually hired the worker.
- **Category Depth:** They cover a vast range of skills, from heavy construction (backhoe operators) to domestic repairs (plumbers).

### 4. Critical Gaps & Limitations

- **The "Dead Number" Issue:** Because it is a static directory, many listings become outdated. Users often call numbers that are no longer in service or workers who are no longer active.
- **No Real-Time Availability:** There is no way to know if a worker is currently busy or available for an emergency.
- **Information Leakage:** Since phone numbers are public, workers are often exposed to spam calls, and the platform has no way to track how many successful jobs are actually being created.
- **No Post-Job Security:** Once the contact is made, the platform has no record of the work done, the price paid, or the quality of the finished service.